

Table 1

The difference between Xamarin Forms and Xamarin Native	
Xamarin Native	Xamarin Forms
Separate UI for each platform	Single UI for all platforms
Supports up to 70 per cent code reuse	It allows more code sharing (90-100 per cent code reuse)
Comparatively slower development cycle	Faster development cycle
Expertise in platform-specific native UIs is required	No platform-specific native UI knowledge required
Wide variety of UI and third-party libraries available and it supports non-portable .NET libraries	Limited number of third-party libraries
App's performance close to that of native apps	Performance is slightly slower
Recommended where code sharing is not that important vis-à-vis a custom UI	Recommended when code sharing is more important
Best for apps that require platform-specific functionality	Best for apps with interactions that require little native behaviour
Most suitable for apps that require specialised interactions	Most suitable for apps that are data-driven (listviews, data entry fields, etc)

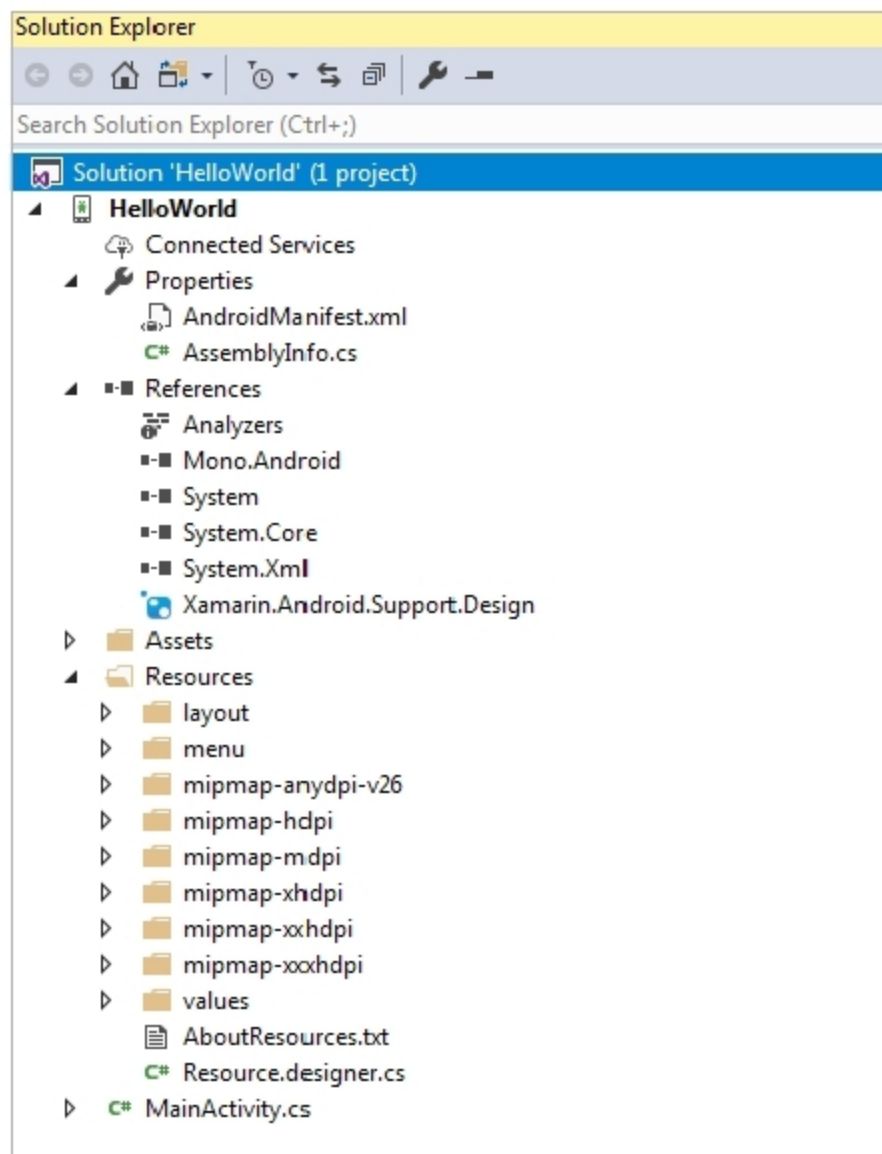


Figure 6: Solution Explorer for Xamarin Android Project

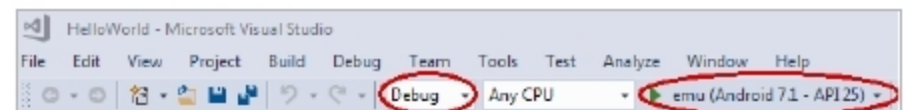


Figure 7: Running the Xamarin app

Go with the default option of creating a *Single View App* for now and choose the *Minimum Android SDK Version* for this application. Click on the *OK* button. This will generate your project. Look at the solution in *Solution Explorer*, as shown in Figure 6. Run the application.

In Visual Studio, select the configuration, i.e., *Debug/Release* and the device/emulator on which you want to run the application.

Now click on the device name to run the application in the selected configuration. Your application is now running.

In this article, we have explored the basics of Xamarin development and looked at how to create a sample application. Developers should consider several key factors before creating mobile applications that deliver a high quality user experience. They should consider business needs and the goal of the application as the key factors while choosing the right development approach. **END** 🐧

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